

How I'd Start a 1-Person Business + Personal Brand with AI (In 30 Days)

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 24, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d8Q829FF_NA Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter — \$20M+ earned online, 15,000+ students coached — breaks down a three-phase, 30-day blueprint to start a profitable one-person service business using AI tools, social content, and automated DM funnels.

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Phase 1: Ideation — Choosing What to Sell 0:46

- The entire system starts with picking the right type of business
 - Two macro options: **product-based** or **service-based**
 - Product-based (e.g., supplements) = high startup cost + high overhead = easier to fail
 - Businesses fail when they run out of money; high overhead accelerates that risk
 - Service-based = low startup cost, low overhead, fastest path to profit
 - Brandon's first successful business was online training — how he made his first million
- For anyone unsure what service to offer, use an AI prompt:
 - Open Claude, ChatGPT, or Grok
 - Prompt: **"I'm thinking of starting a service-based business. Interview me, and once you have enough questions about me and my expertise, come up with some options of businesses I can start."**
 - This surfaces business ideas based on your existing skills and background
- Examples of service businesses that fit the model:
 - Online fitness coaching / personal training
 - AI automation setup for businesses

- Video editing for entrepreneurs

Pricing Structure & the High-Ticket Logic 1:36

- Pricing depends on how involved you are in delivery
 - Low-involvement (e.g., a course sold via a link) → low price, self-serve checkout
 - High-involvement, hands-on (e.g., 1-on-1 coaching) → high-ticket, sold via sales calls
- Recommended pricing ladder for online fitness coaching:

Package	Price	Notes
16-week program	\$997	Floor, not ceiling
4-week (monthly)	\$297	Mid-tier downsell
Weekly	\$80/week	Everyone can afford this

- Comparison to in-person training: a gym trainer can cost $\$100/\text{session} \times 3\text{x}/\text{week} = \text{\$300/week}$, and doesn't track macros or daily check-ins
- **The math behind 25 clients:** 25 clients $\times$ $\$80/\text{week} \times 52 \text{ weeks} =$ roughly **\\$104,000/year** — six figures as a solo operator
- Nobody buys $\$997+$ by clicking a link in a bio — sales calls are required for high ticket
 - Exception: extreme credibility (e.g., The Rock) — but that's not the starting position
- Sales call cascade strategy:
 - Primary target: close at $\$997$ (16-week package)
 - Downsell 1: $\$297/\text{month}$ if they can't commit to $\$997$
 - Downsell 2: $\$80/\text{week}$ if they still hesitate — virtually no objection at this price
- Student proof — Anna Quinn (Dallas, TX, age 22):
 - Was an in-person trainer; had made only $\$300$ online before joining Brandon's program
 - After 8 months in the High Ticket Trainer program: **\\$80,000 in online coaching revenue**
 - Her father told her she made more in 4 months than he did

Phase 2: The Testimonial Harvest 1:59

- Before marketing to strangers, build credibility with real results
- Step-by-step process:
 - Tell everyone you know — friends, family, college/high school contacts — you're looking for people to work with **for free**
 - Post on all social media platforms announcing the free offer
 - Work with **at least 5 people** for free in exchange for testimonials
 - Choose clients most likely to get dramatic results fast

- For fitness: target people with the most weight to lose — they lose fastest and produce the most striking before/after
- Brandon once helped a client lose 70 lbs in 70 days — only possible with someone significantly overweight
- Work with them long enough to produce a meaningful result (fitness: ~1 month minimum)
- After delivering results:
 - Ask for a testimonial you can use in marketing
 - Offer to continue working together at a **discounted rate** (e.g., half price) as a thank-you for beta testing
 - These are your easiest first paying clients — you've already helped them and they want to keep going
 - Fitness clients still have progress to make after a month
 - AI automation clients need someone to maintain the system
 - Video editing clients will always need more videos
- Student proof — Will:
 - Ran a testimonial harvest, got strong testimonials
 - Made **\$5,940 in his first 7 days** of selling
 - Hit **\$32,000+ since August 8th** (his first month in the program)



Phase 3: Social Media Marketing Strategy 2:46

- Goal: you don't need to go viral or have massive followers — you only need **25 clients**
 - There are likely already 25 people in your current following who'd work with you
 - 25 clients = \$100K+/year; achievable without paid ads
- Posting cadence: **3 times per day** on each platform
 - Platforms: Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, TikTok
 - Same video can be cross-posted to all three
 - Instagram is the primary income driver; TikTok and YouTube supplement with additional leads
- Two methods to find what content to make:
 - **Free tool — Viral Content Architect** (link in description):
 - Input your niche and target market
 - Outputs 20 short-form video ideas with script outlines
 - **Niche Hacking** (Brandon's proprietary strategy):
 - Search your niche in the Instagram search bar
 - Find "10x outliers" — videos with 10× more views than the creator has followers
 - Remake those videos in your own style (don't copy — adapt with your own perspective)
 - Analogy: learning guitar by playing other people's songs before writing your own (Beatles, Muddy Waters, Buddy Guy)
- For fitness creators specifically: **Viral Content Vault for Online Trainers**

- A curated, constantly updated database of 10x outlier videos
- Updated nearly daily with hundreds of examples — removes the guesswork
- 100% free
- Paid option — **VidIQ**: shows outlier videos on Instagram by niche; helps identify what's working
- Student proof — Corey Armstrong:
 - Started with fewer than 1,000 followers
 - Grew to **300,000 Instagram followers** and nearly **300,000 YouTube subscribers** almost entirely through niche hacking (often hacking Brandon's own content)
 - Last reported month: **\$40,000**
 - Last full year: **\$470,000**

The Content-to-Client Funnel (DM Automation) 2:46

- Getting views alone doesn't generate revenue — the funnel converts attention into booked calls
- Full funnel flow:
 - Post a short-form video with a **comment call to action** (e.g., "Comment SHRED for a custom meal plan" or "Comment A1C for my free diabetes guide")
 - An automation detects the comment keyword and **automatically DMs** the commenter a free tool or resource
 - You (or the system) opens a conversation: reference what they downloaded and qualify them
 - Run a **DM sales script** to warm them up and book a sales call
 - On the sales call: close at \$997, downsell if needed
 - Target conversion: **5% of DM conversations** to sales calls — sufficient to hit 25 clients
- Why this works without being salesy:
 - You're giving something away for free — you never seem pushy
 - Leads are **inbound** — no cold DMing, no chasing people
- What to give away — ranked by effectiveness:
 - PDF / cheat sheet / checklist (lowest engagement)
 - Free mini-course
 - **Interactive tool / mini web app** (highest engagement — recommended)
 - Built inside **Go High Level**: users input data (height, weight, age, goal) and get an instant personalized result (e.g., macro targets)
 - Example tools built: macro tracker, personalized 90-day transformation plan, ripped road map
 - Far more compelling than a Google Doc or PDF — feels professional, delivers instant value
- Automation setup example inside Go High Level:
 - Trigger: someone comments "RIPPED" on an Instagram post
 - Action: system automatically DMs them the Ripped Road Map tool
 - Takes minutes to configure; runs 24/7 without manual effort

- Content scheduling:
 - Connect Instagram, YouTube, TikTok to Go High Level
 - Batch-create content and schedule all posts in advance — no manual daily posting
- Student results using this exact funnel:
 - Brian: signed 3 clients in one week; **\$18,000 in that month**
 - Justin: **\$10,000 in one week**; \$245,000 for the year
 - Karet: \$10K/month, **\$245,000 for the year** (using basic funnel + later added email/SMS via GHL)

Tools Stack & Free Resources 3:54

Tool	Cost	Purpose
Claude / ChatGPT / Grok	Free	Business ideation interview prompt
Viral Content Architect	Free	20 short-form content ideas with script outlines
Viral Content Vault (fitness)	Free	Daily-updated 10x outlier video database
Fitness Revenue Roadmap	Free	9-question quiz → personalized business game plan
VidIQ	Paid	Find outlier videos by niche on Instagram/YouTube
Go High Level	Free 30-day trial	CRM, content scheduling, DM automation, mini web app builder, email/SMS

- **Go High Level** is the central operating system of the entire business:
 - Automates comment-to-DM sequences
 - Schedules and publishes content to all platforms
 - Builds interactive free tools (mini web apps) without coding
 - Scales into email and text marketing as revenue grows
 - Free 30-day trial, no obligation — link in description
- **Fitness Revenue Roadmap**: ~4-minute, 9-question quiz that outputs a customized growth plan; trained on 10 years of Brandon's teachings and community conversations

The entire system boils down to one repeatable loop: post value → trigger a comment keyword → auto-DM a free tool → start a conversation → book a sales call → close. Repeat until you have 25 clients and six figures.